

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

H	A	N	G
R	A	T	E

Ladder 2

C	O	A	T
T	H	E	M

Ladder 3

L	U	C	K
P	O	O	L

Ladder 4

L	A	T	E
N	O	T	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

H	A	N	G
H	A	N	D
H	A	R	D
H	A	R	E
R	A	R	E
R	A	T	E

Ladder 2

C	O	A	T
C	H	A	T
T	H	A	T
T	H	A	N
T	H	E	N
T	H	E	M

Ladder 3

L	U	C	K
L	O	C	K
L	O	O	K
T	O	O	K
T	O	O	L
P	O	O	L

Ladder 4

L	A	T	E
L	A	N	E
C	A	N	E
C	O	N	E
N	O	N	E
N	O	T	E